ELIXIR-UK at 10: new members and activities

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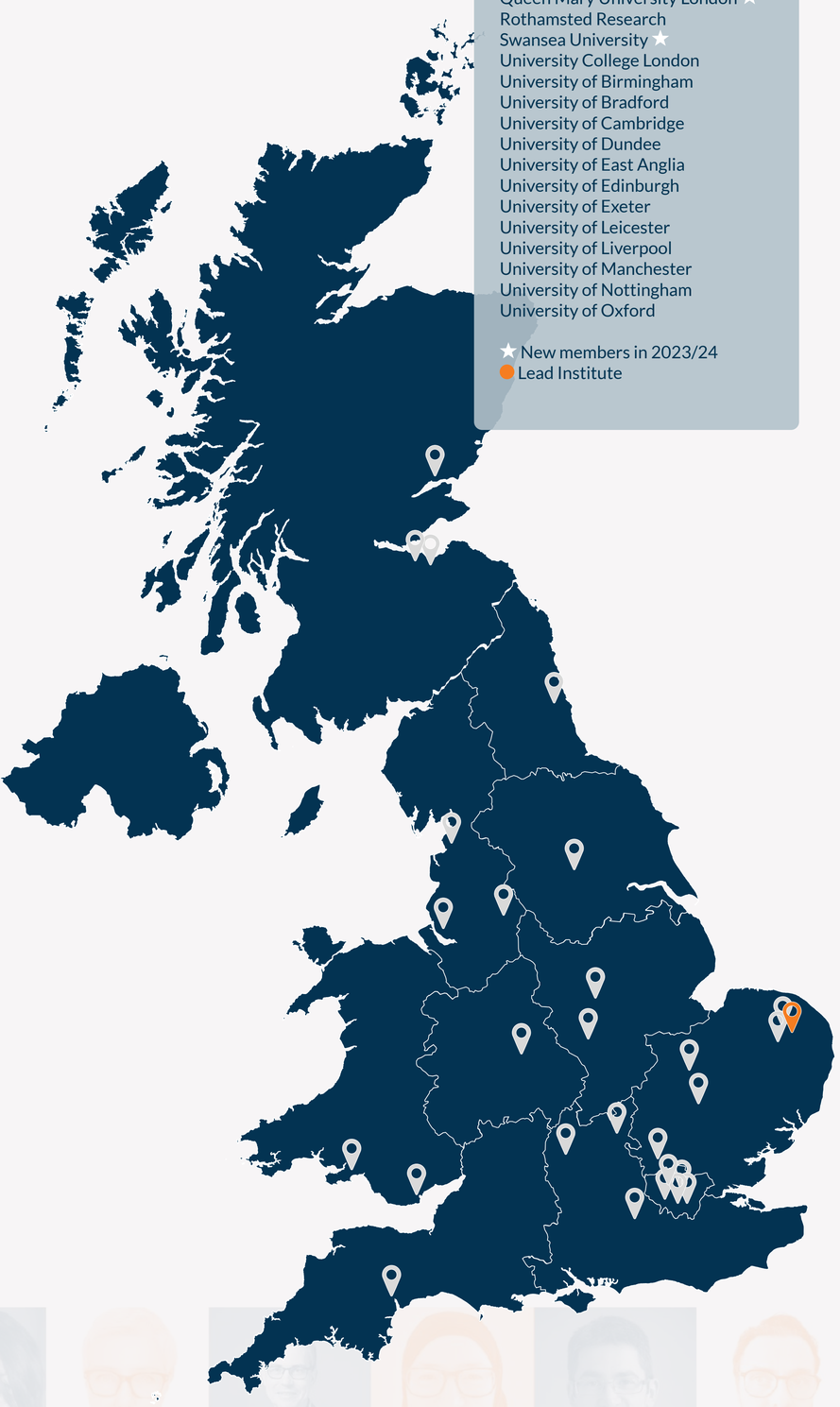
1 – Earlham Institute, Norwich Research Park, Norwich, UK
2 – ELIXIR-UK, c/o Earlham Institute, Norwich Research Park, Norwich, UK
3 – The University of Manchester, Manchester, UK

28
members

- Cardiff University
- Centre for Ecology and Hydrology
- Earlham Institute ●
- HDR UK ★
- Heriot-Watt University
- Imperial College
- King's College London
- Newcastle University
- Open Life Science (OLS)
- Open University
- Pirbright Institute ★
- Quadram Institute
- Queen Mary University London ★
- Rothamsted Research
- Swansea University ★
- University College London
- University of Birmingham
- University of Bradford
- University of Cambridge
- University of Dundee
- University of East Anglia
- University of Edinburgh
- University of Exeter
- University of Leicester
- University of Liverpool
- University of Manchester
- University of Nottingham
- University of Oxford

★ New members in 2023/24
● Lead Institute



Opening routes for UK researchers to collaborate with European partners across ELIXIR

ELIXIR-UK has represented UK strengths in life science research since 2013, providing a route for UK researchers and resources to participate in ELIXIR. The UK Node is made up of a growing number of research-performing organisations throughout the UK, with four new members joining in the last year for a total of 28.

Leading on ELIXIR Europe activities and projects

1 Platform Lead

5 Community Leads

7 Focus Group Leads, participation in all

13 EU projects involved in

Building UK-wide communities of practice

RDM Club: monthly meeting that brings expert views from the UK and Europe and lively discussions on RDM topics and resources.

Training Club: bi-monthly meeting with speakers from UK and European organisations that focus on capacity building and upskilling in bioinformatics and computational biology.

UK Human Data Community: a newly formed group uniting and aligning in the UK the different ELIXIR Europe Communities and Focus Groups on health data, federated human data, rare diseases, cancer data and human copy number variations.

Data Stewardship Fellowship: an ambassador programme spanning 17 UK research-performing organisations. 24 Fellows over 3 years have created and delivered training locally, seeded RDM communities of practice and signposted ELIXIR-UK resources and goals. The impact of the Fellowship has brought new members, collaborations and knowledge to the UK Node.

Supporting open-access services for the life sciences community with increased visibility and exposure

ELIXIR-UK plays a crucial role in amplifying the reach and sustainability of a portfolio of 31 open-access services provided by the UK life sciences community. In December 2023, ELIXIR announced the addition of four ELIXIR-UK services as Core Data Resources and three as Recommended Interoperability Resources.

Enabling and improving Trusted Research Environments (TREs)

Through the TRE-FX UKRI-funded project and the EOSC-ENTRUST EU project, partners from ELIXIR-UK members are demonstrating how analysis tools can securely access multiple TREs and how to integrate the fragmented European landscape.

This work aims to enable researchers to easily perform an analysis across multiple TREs, widening the scope of their research and making more effective use of the UK's data.

Conceiving the BioCommons infrastructure for UK life science researchers

Modern biology rests on the generation, sharing and integrated analysis of digital data. Numerous policies and initiatives supporting the principles that research data should be Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable (FAIR) have gained global traction in recent years.

Therefore, ELIXIR-UK conceived BioFAIR, a new digital research infrastructure that will address this urgent need for more effective data management and reproducible data processing workflows.

In 2023, UK Research and Innovation (UKRI) announced a five-year funding of £34 million for BioFAIR, subject to business case approvals. The project started its stakeholder engagement at the ELIXIR-UK All Hands 2023, followed by a Roadshow across the UK, which is currently underway.

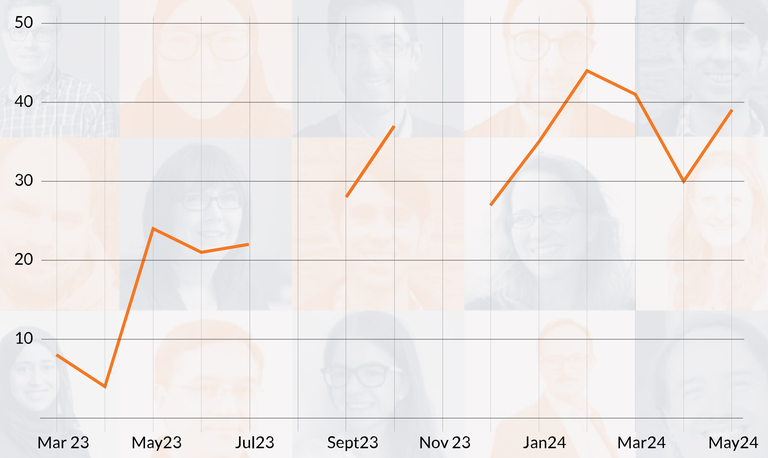
Visit our other UK Node posters

ELIXIR-UK Fellowship	BioFAIR
17	**72**

Connecting and growing: 2024 community engagement

UK RDM Club growth

The UK RDM Club has seen a significant rise in participation throughout 2024. From just 8 attendees in early 2023, the club now averages 38 attendees per month. This growth is fueled by a series of compelling presentations on trending RDM topics, featuring speakers from the UK and other ELIXIR Nodes.



Boost in LinkedIn engagement

Our LinkedIn presence has surged in 2024, following a strategic focus on this social platform. We have gained 410 new followers, up from 200, marking a dramatic increase in engagement. Page views have soared by 288.1%, unique visitors by 200%, and reactions by 411.8% compared to the previous year.

476 Reactions ▲ 411.8%

683 Page views ▲ 288.1%

410 New followers ▲ 1,105.9%

619 Total followers

Enhanced internal communications

Internal communications have also improved, with a 10% increase in email open rates and an impressive 85% rise in click-through rates for our news and updates. This indicates a growing interest and engagement from our members.

39% Open rate ▲ 11%

8.4% Click rate ▲ 85%

0 Unsubscribes

200+ Members

Biotechnology and Biological Sciences Research Council

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